

Power BI Developer – 100 Interview Questions & Answers

Basics & Fundamentals

Q1. What is Power BI?

A: A business intelligence tool that helps visualize and share insights from data.

Q2. Difference between Power BI Desktop and Service?

A: Desktop is for report building; Service is for sharing and collaboration.

Q3. What is Power BI Report Server?

A: An on-premises server for hosting and managing Power BI reports.

Q4. What is the difference between a Dashboard and a Report?

A: Dashboard is a single-page view; Report can have multiple pages.

Q5. What are building blocks of Power BI?

A: Datasets, Reports, Dashboards, Tiles, and Visualizations.

Data Modeling

Q6. What is a Star Schema?

A: A central fact table linked to multiple dimension tables for optimized reporting.

Q7. Difference between Star and Snowflake Schema?

A: Star has denormalized dimensions; Snowflake has normalized, multi-level dimensions.

Q8. What is a Relationship in Power BI?

A: A defined link between tables based on keys to enable accurate data analysis.

Q9. What are Fact and Dimension tables?

A: Fact tables store numeric data; Dimension tables store descriptive attributes.

Q10. What is Cardinality in relationships?

A: Describes the data relationship (1:1, 1:many, many:many).

DAX Functions

Q11. What is DAX?

A: Data Analysis Expressions, a formula language in Power BI.

Q12. Difference between Calculated Column and Measure?

A: Calculated columns are row-level; Measures are aggregate-level.

Q13. What does CALCULATE function do?

A: Modifies the context of a calculation.

Q14. What does RELATED function do?

A: Fetches values from a related table.

Q15. Explain ALL function in DAX.

A: Removes filters from a column or table.

Power Query

Q16. What is Power Query?

A: A data transformation tool in Power BI.

Q17. Difference between Merge and Append?

A: Merge combines columns; Append stacks rows.

Q18. What language does Power Query use?

A: M language.

Q19. How to handle missing data?

A: Remove nulls, replace values, or apply conditional logic.

Q20. How to optimize Power Query?

A: Reduce applied steps, filter early, disable load for staging queries.

Visualization & Reporting

Q21. What is Drill-through?

A: Allows users to navigate to a detailed report page.

Q22. What is a Slicer?

A: A visual filter for easy user interaction.

Q23. What are Bookmarks?

A: Save report states for navigation or storytelling.

Q24. What is Conditional Formatting?

A: Changing visual appearance based on values.

Q25. What are Custom Visuals?

A: Third-party visuals imported to enhance reporting.

Performance Optimization

Q26. How to improve performance in Power BI?

A: Use star schema, reduce calculated columns, optimize DAX, limit visuals.

Q27. Import vs DirectQuery performance?

A: Import is faster but less real-time; DirectQuery is real-time but slower.

Q28. What is Aggregation in Power BI?

A: Pre-summarizing data to improve performance.

Q29. How to reduce file size?

A: Remove unused columns, optimize data types, disable auto date/time.

Q30. What is Query Reduction?

A: Minimizing queries sent to the data source.

Security

Q31. What is Row Level Security (RLS)?

A: Restricts data visibility per user role.

Q32. What is Object Level Security?

A: Restricts access to specific tables or columns.

Q33. What are Roles in Power BI?

A: Security configurations defining access levels.

Q34. Difference between Static and Dynamic RLS?

A: Static assigns filters manually; Dynamic applies based on logged-in user.

Q35. How to implement RLS?

A: Define roles in Desktop and publish with security filters.

Integration & Deployment

Q36. What is a Gateway in Power BI?

A: Bridge between on-premises data and Power BI Service.

Q37. Difference between Personal and Enterprise Gateway?

A: Personal is user-specific; Enterprise supports multiple users and data sources.

Q38. How to schedule data refresh?

A: Configure refresh in Power BI Service under dataset settings.

Q39. How to publish a report?

A: Use 'Publish' in Desktop to upload to a workspace in Service.

Q40. What are Apps in Power BI?

A: Packaged dashboards and reports shared with users.

Advanced Scenarios

Q41. Can Power BI integrate with R/Python?

A: Yes, for advanced analytics and visuals.

Q42. What are Paginated Reports?

A: Pixel-perfect reports designed for printing/exporting.

Q43. What is Incremental Refresh?

A: Loads only new/changed data instead of full dataset reload.

Q44. Can you embed Power BI into applications?

A: Yes, using Power BI Embedded API.

Q45. What is Composite Model?

A: Combines Import and DirectQuery modes in one model.

Real-World Scenarios

Q46. How do you handle large datasets?

A: Use aggregations, partitions, incremental refresh, optimize schema.

Q47. How to share a report with external users?

A: Through Power BI Service with guest access or Power BI Embedded.

Q48. How do you handle version control?

A: Using Power BI templates (.pbit) or source control with scripts.

Q49. Scenario: User sees wrong numbers?

A: Check relationships, filters, and DAX measures for context issues.

Q50. Scenario: Slow performance in DirectQuery?

A: Optimize source database, reduce visuals, enable aggregations.

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